the quote is successfully returned. If we change the `end` attribute to anything less than 5, the query will not return the search term. The query returns successfully if the value for the `end` attribute is anything greater than 5 (6, 7, 10, and so on).

12.8.3 The span_near query

In the `span_first` query, the query word is always counted from the starting position (position 1). Instead of finding the word if it exists in the first *n* positions, sometimes we want to find words that are nearer to each other. For example, continuing with Newton's quote, suppose we want to determine whether the words *Plato* and *Aristotle* are next to each other or no further than three or four positions apart. As figure 12.10 illustrates, we obtain positive results if we are searching for a quote where Plato and Aristotle differ by three positions.

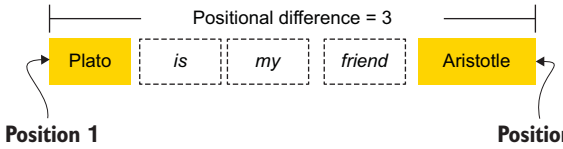


Figure 12.10 Words expected to be at a specified distance apart

In addition to finding the difference in distance between these words, we may want them to exist in the same order. The next listing shows a query to determine if *Plato* and *Aristotle* are near each other (about three positions from each other).

Listing 12.16 Searching for documents with terms near each other

```
GET quotes/_search
{
  "query": {
    "span_near": {
      "clauses": [
        {
          "span_term": {
            "quote": "plato"
          }
        },
        {
          "span_term": {
            "quote":  "aristotle"
          }
        }
      ],
      "slop": 3,
      "in_order": true
    }
  }
}
```

The span_near query definition with a couple of clauses

The clauses consisting of two independent span_terms to search for individual words

The slop attribute gives the acceptable number of positions between the words.

The in_order attribute sets the order of the attributes.